

Section B

In Section B, students will be asked to compare in detail an extract of one of the set works with an extract from an unfamiliar listening piece (related to one of the set works). Students will hear the pieces and see the scores. This question will be worth 12 marks.

The question will be an extended response assessed for the quality of musical knowledge and understanding demonstrated as well as the quality of the evaluation and conclusion. This question will focus on the stylistic features of the music and will draw on the students' knowledge from the study of the set works. Students should be prepared to demonstrate that they are able to demonstrate their knowledge and understanding of, and evaluate, musical elements, musical contexts and musical language. Questions may include any of the following:

- how the musical elements (pitch, tonality, structure, sonority, texture, tempo, metre, rhythm, and dynamics) have been used by the composer/performer
- how the instruments and groups of instruments are used
- how any other key musical elements have been used in the pieces
- how the two pieces compare together to meet a purpose, audience or other factor
- placing the music in its musical, historical, social and cultural context
- expressing and justifying opinions on the pieces in question.

The essay question will involve comparing one of the set works with an unfamiliar piece. There will be scores accompanying this question for both extracts of music. The question will be focused on an evaluation of certain stylistic aspects of the music. This will be extended writing in which the student will show how they can apply their knowledge in a comparison exercise. This may include making evaluative and critical judgements on the pieces as well as making stylistic connections between the two pieces.

Credit will be given if other music is referred to in students' answers – this could be from the suggested wider listening pieces or any other relevant works studied by the student.

Students will need to know how the works fit within the context of other pieces written in similar genres around the same time.

Students should be encouraged to express their ideas about music using accurate musical vocabulary.

Students must not bring any materials into the examination.

Sample Assessment Materials

A sample paper and mark scheme for this component can be found in the *Pearson Edexcel Level 1/Level 2 GCSE (9–1) in Music* Sample Assessment Materials (SAMs) document.